

Inter-Agency Standing Committee (IASC) Humanitarian Reset Roadmap

21 October 2025

Vision: A humanitarian system that is locally led and globally supported, rooted in communities and driven by greatest need. We will uphold principles, defend humanitarian space, and put protection – especially of women and girls – at the center. By reducing duplication and bureaucracy, ending turf wars, and transitioning to locally led response, we will deliver faster, fairer, and more accountable humanitarian action.

DEFINE – Focus on Greatest Needs

Cut through bureaucracy to ensure that scarce resources reach people in most severe need guided by evidence and streamlined planning.

	Action	Timeline	Lead	Status
1.	Hyper-prioritized Global Humanitarian Overview (GHO), focused on 114 million people most in need in 2025 .	Q1 2025	HPC-SG	Delivered
2.	Embed resilience-building and planned transitions out of humanitarian action into all operations, including via joint analysis/planning approaches.	Ongoing	EDG	Scale-up
3.	Hyper-prioritized GHO focused on those most in need 2026.	Q4 2025	HWG/ HPC-SG	Progressing
4.	Reprioritise 20 country plans (+25% reduction) and transition out of 8 operations .	Q2 2026	EDG	Progressing
5.	Simplify planning and appeals , rooted in communities' priorities - sharply reducing process for operational partners.	Q4 2025	HPC-SG	Progressing
6.	Institutionalise community consultations to define collective priorities.	Q1 2026	HWG	Scale-up

DELIVER – Timely & Streamlined Response

Reform coordination to be lighter, inclusive, and context-specific, enabling timely and efficient response.

7.	Coordinated and principled humanitarian action , with protection and the rights of women and girls at the center – under the strategic leadership of HCs/HCTs and backed by pooled and other funding.	Q4 2025	HCS/ HCTs	Scale-up
8.	Accountability to crisis-affected people – including women and girls survivors of sexual violence – by increasing their participation and directing more funding to women-led organisations.	Q1 2026	HCS/ HCTs	Scale-up
9.	Scale-up multi-purpose cash assistance wherever feasible and appropriate, with local actors fully involved.	Q2 2026	IASC*	Scale-up
10.	Streamline clusters (from 11 and 4 AoRs to 8) - with HCs/HCTs activating only those needed (if any), enabling local actors to co-lead where possible, and reviewing options for further reduction .	Q4 2025	HWG	Progressing
11.	Greater integration between cluster and refugee coordination models, [<i>working towards one humanitarian coordination model</i>].	Q4 2025	UNHCR/OCHA	Progressing
12.	Streamline IASC structures by reducing layers and meetings.	Sept 2025	ERC / IASC	Delivered

DEVOLVE – People-Centered

Shift decision-making, resources, and accountability to affected communities and local actors as the drivers of humanitarian response.

13.	Empower leaders in country , with HCTs and HCs operating as strategic, unified crisis platforms, with stronger accountability and performance management.	Q4 2025	IASC/EDG	Scale-up
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* IASC Principals will stand up ad-hoc, time-bound advice groups on defined questions.

14. HCs/HCTs to be held accountable on delivering against priorities identified by affected people , agreed through a consultation and validation process.	Q1 2026	HCs/ HCTs	Scale-up
15. HCs and HCTs to opt for context-specific coordination models built around the needs, priorities and capacities of communities (<i>including using ABC, streamlined clusters, or other approaches</i>), with leadership by local actors where possible .	Q4 2025	HCs/ HCTs	Scale-up
16. Commit UN and INGOs to more equitable partnerships with local and national actors , based on trust and recognition and coordinated institutional capacity strengthening, and reflect this in HCT practice and partner engagement.	Q1 2026	HCs/ HCTs	Scale-up
17. Operationalize the Reset principle of “ <i>as local as possible, as international as necessary</i> ” by embedding local leadership, representation, financing, and measurable localization targets across all levels of humanitarian action.	Q1 2026	HCs/ HCTs	Scale-up
18. Significantly increase funding to country pooled funds, with ERC aspiration of 70% of pooled funding channelled to local actors , including women-led organisations. Strengthen the pooled funds to deliver at a more ambitious level.	Q3 2026	ERC	Scale-up

DEFEND – Principles & Humanitarian Space

Uphold humanitarian principles, protect space for action, and advocate collectively for those most at risk.

19. Unequivocally uphold humanitarian principles and consistent application of International Humanitarian Law (IHL).	Ongoing	ERC/IASC	Ongoing
20. Consistent messaging and protection of our collective work on gender, and against sexual exploitation, abuse and harassment (SEA/SH).	Ongoing	ERC/IASC	Ongoing
21. Shared advocacy for protection of civilians & humanitarian workers .	Ongoing	ERC/IASC	Ongoing
22. Protect space for agile and creative humanitarian diplomacy .	Ongoing	UN80	Progressing
23. Launch campaigns to connect with publics, parliaments, and private actors – making the case afresh for humanitarian solidarity, with nations beyond governments aiming to deliver 1% for those in dire.	Ongoing	ERC/IASC	Ongoing

ENABLERS – Partnerships, Resources & Efficiency

Unlock transformation through innovation, broader financing, and streamlined systems.

24. Sustain engagement to bring in new partners and sources of finance .	Ongoing	DG	Ongoing
25. Bring together scaled up anticipatory action and a ‘ green humanitarian reset ’ that is ready for the climate challenges ahead.	Ongoing	IASC*	Ongoing
26. Increase advocacy with development actors and International Financial Institutions (IFIs) on resilience building and root causes of crises.	Ongoing	DG	Ongoing
27. Work with donors to reduce conditionality and reporting requirements , step up to the quid pro quo of the Grand Bargain, and provide predictable, flexible funding .	Ongoing	Grand Bargain	Scale-up
28. Shared services by the UN or others by default (<i>including coordination, needs assessments, risk management, pooled data systems and information management, back-office support, supply chains, communication, premises and logistics</i>).	Oct 2025	UN80 in collaboration with IASC	Progressing
29. Innovate so that tech/AI is part of the solution .	Q4 2025	IASC*	Planned
30. Define unique roles & value of UN, INGOs, LNAs to ensure complementarity.	Q4 2025	IASC*	Planned

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